

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

Date	28 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-6819
Team Leader	Hazna Mariyam. H
Team Members	Anuskha. K Theras Jasmine. M
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization :

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Selected Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops require manual triage, routing, and configuration assignment. This step is prone to oversight and delays, leading to high user wait times and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.



Brainstorm & idea prioritization

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

- 10 minutes to prepare
- 1 hour to collaborate
- 2-8 people recommended

Before you collaborate

A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what you need to do to get going.

10 minutes

A

Team gathering
Define who should participate in the session and send an invite. Share relevant information or pre-work ahead.

B

Set the goal
Think about the problem you'll be focusing on solving in the brainstorming session.

C

Learn how to use the facilitation tools
Use the Facilitation Superpowers to run a happy and productive session.

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1 Define your problem statement

What problem are you trying to solve? Frame your problem as a How Might We statement. This will be the focus of your brainstorm.

5 minutes

PROBLEM

How might we [your problem statement]?

Key rules of brainstorming

To run a smooth and productive session

Stay in topic.

Defer judgment.

Go for volume.

Encourage wild ideas.

Listen to others.

If possible, be visual.

Project Objective:

To design and implement an automated workflow using ServiceNow's Flow Designer that triggers upon Service Catalog request approval, automatically creates a Catalog Task with detailed configuration requirements, and assigns it directly to the Hardware assignment group.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

During the ideation session, the team explored three distinct technical approaches to solve the manual procurement bottleneck:

Category 1: Traditional / Legacy Scripting Approach

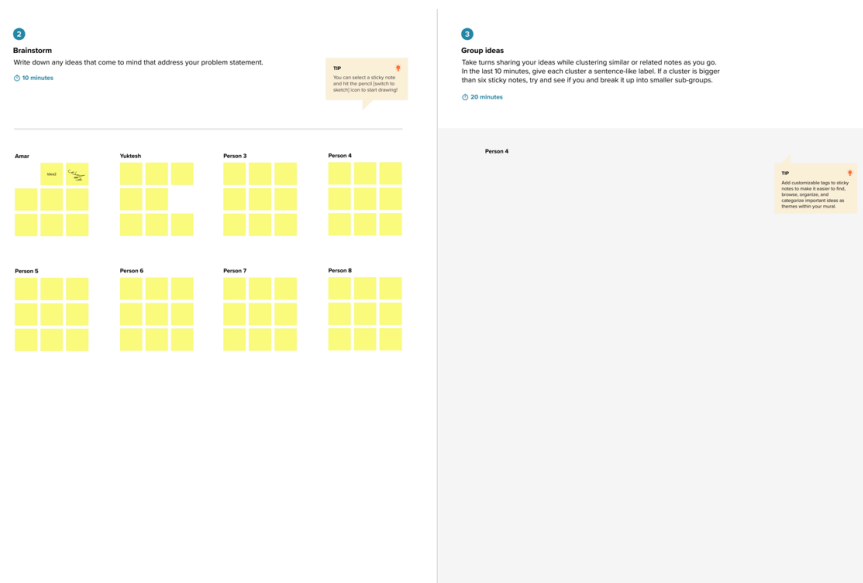
- **Idea 1.1:** Use legacy Workflow Editor (v_workflow) to handle approvals and task generation.
- **Idea 1.2:** Implement custom server-side Business Rules (after insert/update) on the `sc_req_item` table to create `sc_task` records programmatically using JavaScript.

Category 2: Low-Code Automation (ServiceNow Flow Designer)

- **Idea 2.1:** Build a low-code Flow in **Flow Designer** triggered by Service Catalog requests. Automatically create and assign the Catalog Task to the **Hardware** group with pre-configured short descriptions upon approval.

Category 3: External Integration Approach

- **Idea 3.1:** Integrate third-party automation tools (e.g., Zapier/Make) via REST APIs to listen for ServiceNow orders and dispatch task assignments externally.



Step-3: Idea Prioritization

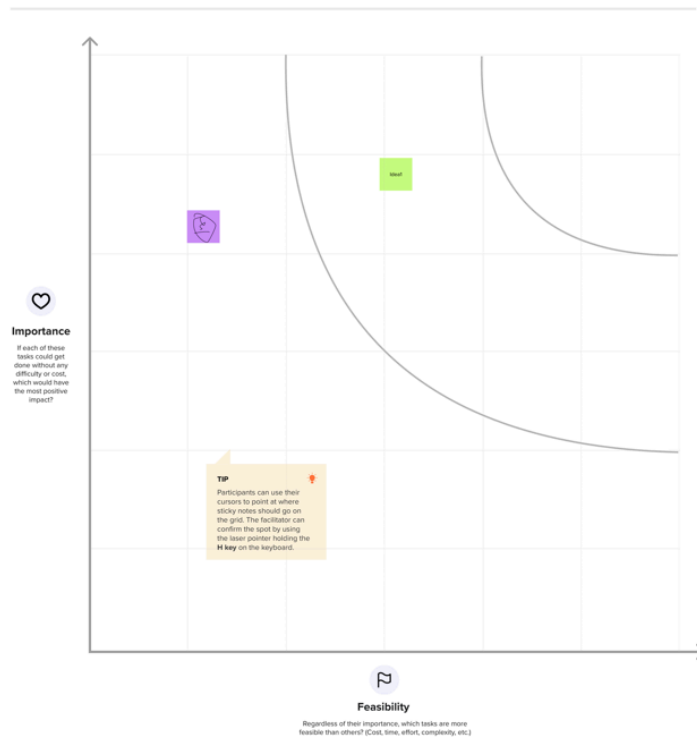
Solution Approach	Impact (1-5)	Feasibility / Ease of Implementation (1-5)	Maintainability (1-5)	Priority Rank	Status
Option A: Custom Business Rules (JavaScript)	3	2	2	Rank 3	Rejected (High code maintenance , harder to debug/audit) .
Option B: Flow Designer Automation	4	5	5	Rank 1	Selected (Native low-code, optimal performance , clean UI, upgrade-safe).
Option C: External REST Integration	5	2	2	Rank 2	Rejected (Unnecessary network overhead and security complexity).

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Prioritize

Your team should all be on the same page about what's important moving forward. Place your ideas on this grid to determine which ideas are important and which are feasible.

🕒 20 minutes



Justification for Selected Solution (Flow Designer):

1. **Native Integration:** Direct integration with ServiceNow Service Catalog and Request Item (`sc_req_item`) lifecycle.
2. **Low-Code Efficiency:** Eliminates complex server scripts, making the process easily maintainable by IT system administrators.
3. **Execution Reliability:** Automatically executes upon request approval, setting assignment group to Hardware and short description to "Laptop need to Configured" without manual oversight.